AUTOMATION & QA DEVELOPER

Task 1 – Web App QA Report

RealWorld Conduit – Manual Functional & Validation Testing

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Assessment	Automation & QA Developer Take-Home Skills Assessment
Test date	10 November 2026
Test approach	Manual browser-based testing

Purpose
This report records the user-visible behaviour observed while testing registration, authentication, articles, and comments. Findings are separated from recommendations where the product's formal requirements were not available.

1. Executive Summary

The RealWorld Conduit application was exercised through key user flows: sign-up, login, article creation, editing, deletion, logout, and comment submission. Core article and comment flows worked in the scenarios tested. The main concerns observed were account-registration validation/uniqueness behaviour and unclear validation feedback.

Testing note: The assessment did not provide a formal product specification for username format or password complexity. Therefore, those behaviours are recorded as potential policy gaps/recommendations rather than definitive violations of a stated requirement.

2. Test Scope and Results

Area	Scenario	Observed result
Registration	Submit signup form with all fields empty	Sign-up button was not clickable; no explanatory validation message was displayed.
Registration	Enter malformed email	Application displayed an invalid-email message. Passed.
Registration	Register with password `123`	Registration proceeded and user was logged in. Password-policy concern; formal policy not supplied.
Registration	Register a second account using an existing username and a different email	Application accepted the registration; duplicate username was observed.
Registration	Submit an already-used email with a different username	Application proceeded to a logged-in state without a duplicate-email message. Exact account/identity outcome needs further verification.
Articles	Create, edit, and delete an article	All three actions succeeded.
Authentication	Logout and view public content	Logout succeeded; public articles remained visible, as expected.
Authentication	Open protected article editor while logged out	Application redirected to login.
Comments	View comments while logged out	Comment form was hidden and login prompt appeared.
Comments	Post a comment and refresh	Comment appeared immediately and remained after refresh.
Comments	Submit an empty comment	Application displayed `body can't be blank`. Passed.
Article validation	Submit a title exceeding the stated limit	Application rejected it with wording reported as `Body title is less than 100 char`; wording is unclear/misleading.

3. Bug Report

The following five findings are based on the observed behaviour. Findings dependent on an unstated product policy are explicitly marked as provisional.

Finding 1: No explanatory feedback when signup fields are empty

Steps to reproduce	1. Open Sign Up. 2. Leave username, email, and password empty. 3. Observe the form and Sign Up button.
Expected	The form should clearly explain that required fields must be completed. If submission is intentionally disabled, the user should still receive clear guidance.
Actual	The Sign Up button was not clickable and no validation message appeared; the page remained unchanged.
Severity	Low
Suspected cause	The UI may disable submission for empty fields without displaying inline guidance or accessible validation feedback.

Finding 2: Very short password accepted at registration

Steps to reproduce	1. Open Sign Up. 2. Enter a valid username and email. 3. Enter password `123`. 4. Submit the form.
Expected	If the product requires a minimum password length or strength, the form and server should enforce that policy and explain it to the user.
Actual	The application accepted the three-character password and proceeded to a logged-in state.
Severity	Medium (provisional)
Suspected cause	A minimum-length/strength policy may be missing or not enforced. The formal password policy was not supplied, so this should be confirmed with product requirements.

Finding 3: Duplicate username accepted during registration

Steps to reproduce	1. Register an account with username `amandhanjal`. 2. Log out. 3. Register another account with the same username and a different email.
Expected	If usernames identify accounts uniquely, the application should reject the duplicate and show a clear message.
Actual	The second registration using the same username was accepted. The user also reported being able to log in using that username.
Severity	Medium (provisional)
Suspected cause	Username uniqueness may not be validated at the API/database layer. Confirm the intended identity model and inspect the stored account records.

Finding 4: Duplicate email registration has unclear handling

Steps to reproduce	1. Register an account with an email address. 2. Log out. 3. Submit Sign Up again with the same email and a different username.
Expected	The application should reject an already-registered email and explain that the address is in use, if email addresses are intended to be unique.
Actual	The application proceeded to a logged-in state without showing a duplicate-email message. The exact account created/authenticated was not conclusively verified.
Severity	Medium (needs verification)
Suspected cause	The registration response may not clearly distinguish a duplicate-email conflict from successful registration, or the API may not enforce email uniqueness. Verify using account records/API response before classifying as confirmed.

Finding 5: Unclear article-title length validation message

Steps to reproduce	1. Open New Article. 2. Enter a title longer than the application's stated limit. 3. Submit the article.
Expected	The application should identify the Title field and state the character limit in clear, grammatically correct wording.
Actual	The application rejected the title and displayed wording reported as `Body title is less than 100 char`.
Severity	Low
Suspected cause	The validation message may use an incorrect field label or poorly written validation text. Confirm the exact message and limit at the UI/API boundary.

4. Root-Cause Analysis – Duplicate Username Registration

During testing, I registered an account using the username `amandhanjal`. After logging out, I submitted another registration using the same username with a different email address. The application accepted the second registration without displaying a duplicate-username warning. I then tested login using that username and was able to proceed, although the precise account selection behaviour should be confirmed against the backend data. This suggests that username uniqueness may not be consistently enforced during registration. I would first inspect the registration API response and the user records to confirm how duplicate usernames are stored and resolved. If usernames are intended to be unique, I would add server-side uniqueness validation and a database unique constraint, handling conflicts safely. Finally, I would return a clear validation response to the UI and add regression tests for duplicate usernames.

5. Recommendations

• Confirm and document the intended username and password policies before treating format/strength behaviour as a defect.
• Enforce unique account identifiers on the server and in the database, not only in the browser.
• Show clear, field-specific feedback when required form fields are empty or invalid.
• Improve the article-title validation wording and verify the exact boundary condition (for example, 99 vs. 100 characters).
• Add regression tests for duplicate usernames/emails, weak passwords, empty signup fields, and validation-message accuracy.

6. Conclusion

The main content workflows tested—article creation, editing, deletion, and comment submission—worked as expected. The most important follow-up areas are account-registration validation and uniqueness handling, plus clearer validation feedback. Some findings remain provisional because the product specification and backend records were not available during this manual test. These should be verified before release or final severity assignment.

Evidence note: Screenshots were not embedded in this report. The observations above are based on the manual test results reported during the assessment walkthrough. Capture screenshots of the relevant signup and validation states if you can reproduce them before final submission.